

Businesses are threatened by security breaches, with hacking being the forerunner, and the threat is continually compounding. According to a professor at California Berkeley University, Dr. Les Labuschagne, businesses approach information security in two different ways. The reactive approach depends on an organization waiting for an attack to happen, then assessing the damages, and fixing the problem, while organizations that use the proactive approach, or as it is labeled as ethical hacking, set policies and procedures in order to prevent attacks occurring in the first place.

When an attack does occur, businesses usually do not report the security breach to the proper authorities because of publicity issues. Many organizations do not want the general public to know about an information security breach, as it may break the trust of its customers. A major factor that may explain this reason is that the company gains no benefit from reporting cyber crime; in contrast, it may actually hurt the organization. The damage or data compromise that the hacker may have committed will not be compensated for.

One solution for an organization to use is cryptography. However, this can be an obstruction and impedes law enforcement. Not only could a business use cryptography, but suspected criminals could also use it to encrypt conversation via the Internet. Though encryption can theoretically be broken, by the time the original data was recovered, the value of the data would have been lost. Though the government could control the use of cryptography, many people feel that it would be a violation of the First Amendment. A second problem arises when considering that the government could only control encryption within the country, but outside of borders, it would have no control.